📘 PDF 1: IELTS MASTER PRACTICE QUESTIONS – PREPLOOM EDITION

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to the **IELTS Master Practice Questions – Preploom Edition**.

This ebook is designed for candidates aiming for **Band 7+ in IELTS Academic**. Inside, you will find **over 100 realistic, exam-standard questions** covering all four skills: Reading, Writing, Listening, and Speaking.

What's Inside

- **Reading** – 30 questions with academic passages (Easy, Medium, Hard)
- **Writing** – 20 questions with sample answers for Task 1 & Task 2
- **Listening** – 25 questions with scripts and answers
- **Speaking** – 25 questions with sample responses for Parts 1, 2, and 3

About IELTS

IELTS (International English Language Testing System) is accepted by universities in the UK, Australia, Canada, and the USA. It focuses on real-life communication and includes both British and international English.

💡 **For full-length mock exams and personalised feedback, visit www.preploom.com.ng**

📚 SECTION 1: IELTS READING (30 Questions)

Academic Module passages. Difficulty: Easy, Medium, Hard.

Questions 1–5 (Easy)

Passage A – The Benefits of Urban Green Spaces

Urban green spaces such as parks, community gardens, and green roofs provide numerous benefits. They reduce air pollution, lower urban temperatures, and improve mental health. A study in Copenhagen found that residents living within 300 metres of a park reported 22%

lower stress levels. Additionally, green spaces increase property values and encourage physical activity.

1. What are three examples of urban green spaces mentioned?

Answer: Parks, community gardens, green roofs.

2. According to the passage, how much lower were stress levels for residents near parks in Copenhagen?

Answer: 22% lower.

3. True or False: Green spaces decrease property values.

Answer: False (they increase property values).

4. What two health-related benefits are mentioned?

Answer: Reduced stress levels and improved mental health.

5. Fill in the blank: Green spaces lower urban _____.

Answer: temperatures.

Questions 6–10 (Medium)

Passage B – The History of Chocolate

Chocolate originates from the cacao bean, first cultivated by the Olmec civilisation in Mesoamerica around 1500 BCE. The Mayans and Aztecs later used cacao beans as currency and to prepare a bitter drink called "xocolātl". After Spanish conquistadors brought cacao to Europe in the 16th century, sugar was added, making it sweet. By the 19th century, the industrial revolution enabled mass production of solid chocolate bars.

6. Which civilisation first cultivated cacao?

Answer: The Olmec civilisation.

7. What was the Aztec name for the bitter chocolate drink?

Answer: Xocolātl.

8. When was cacao brought to Europe?

Answer: In the 16th century.

9. What change made chocolate sweet?

Answer: The addition of sugar.

10. What technological development enabled mass production of chocolate bars?

Answer: The industrial revolution.

Questions 11–15 (Medium)

Passage C – Sleep and Memory Consolidation

Neuroscientists have discovered that sleep plays a critical role in memory consolidation. During slow-wave sleep, the brain replays daily experiences and transfers them from the hippocampus to the neocortex for long-term storage. A 2019 study at the University of California found that participants who napped for 90 minutes performed 40% better on recall tests than those who stayed awake.

11. What is the main function of slow-wave sleep according to the passage?

Answer: Replaying daily experiences and transferring memories from hippocampus to neocortex.

12. Which brain region initially stores new memories?

Answer: The hippocampus.

13. How much better did napping participants perform on recall tests?

Answer: 40% better.

14. True or False: Sleep only affects physical recovery, not memory.

Answer: False.

15. What type of sleep is specifically mentioned for memory processing?

Answer: Slow-wave sleep.

Questions 16–20 (Hard)

Passage D – The Economic Impact of Remote Work

The COVID-19 pandemic accelerated remote work adoption by decades. A Stanford study of 16,000 workers found that remote work increased productivity by 13% due to fewer distractions and quieter environments. However, it also reduced collaboration by 21% and

led to a 5% drop in innovation metrics. Hybrid models (3 days in office, 2 remote) showed the best balance: productivity up 8% and collaboration down only 7%. Commercial real estate demand fell 35% in major cities, while suburban housing prices rose 12%.

16. According to the Stanford study, by what percentage did remote work increase productivity?

Answer: 13%.

17. What negative effect was quantified at 21%?

Answer: Reduction in collaboration.

18. Which work model showed the best balance according to the passage?

Answer: Hybrid model (3 days in office, 2 remote).

19. By how much did commercial real estate demand fall in major cities?

Answer: 35%.

20. True or False: Suburban housing prices fell by 12%.

Answer: False (they rose by 12%).

Questions 21–25 (Hard)

Passage E – Climate Tipping Points

Climate scientists warn that exceeding certain temperature thresholds could trigger irreversible tipping points. The Greenland ice sheet, for example, has a tipping point between 1.5°C and 2.2°C of warming. Beyond this, complete melting would occur over centuries, raising sea levels by 7 metres. Similarly, the Amazon rainforest could turn into savannah with 3–4°C warming, releasing 150 billion tonnes of CO_2. Currently, global warming stands at approximately 1.2°C above pre-industrial levels.

21. What is a "tipping point" as described in the passage?

Answer: A temperature threshold beyond which irreversible changes occur.

22. What would happen if the Greenland ice sheet passes its tipping point?

Answer: Complete melting over centuries, raising sea levels by 7 metres.

23. How much CO_2 could the Amazon release if it turns into savannah?

Answer: 150 billion tonnes.

24. What is the current global warming level mentioned?

Answer: Approximately 1.2°C above pre-industrial levels.

25. Between what temperature range is the Greenland ice sheet's tipping point?

Answer: Between 1.5°C and 2.2°C.

Questions 26–30 (Hard)

Passage F – Neuroplasticity and Learning

Neuroplasticity – the brain's ability to reorganise itself by forming new neural connections – persists throughout adulthood, contrary to earlier beliefs. London taxi drivers, who must memorise 25,000 streets and landmarks, show enlarged posterior hippocampi compared to controls. A 2022 longitudinal study found that learning a second language after age 60 increased grey matter density in the left inferior frontal gyrus by 3–5% over six months. However, neuroplasticity requires consistent effort; skills practiced less than 3 hours per week showed no significant structural change.

26. What is neuroplasticity?

Answer: The brain's ability to reorganise itself by forming new neural connections.

27. Which brain region is enlarged in London taxi drivers?

Answer: The posterior hippocampus.

28. By what percentage did learning a second language increase grey matter density in older adults?

Answer: 3–5%.

29. How many hours per week are needed for significant structural change?

Answer: At least 3 hours per week.

30. True or False: Neuroplasticity only occurs in childhood.

Answer: False (it persists throughout adulthood).

📚 SECTION 2: IELTS WRITING (20 Questions with Sample Answers)

Question 31 (Easy – Task 1)

The chart below shows the percentage of households with internet access in four countries from 2015 to 2020.

- South Korea: 2015: 85%, 2020: 98%
- Germany: 2015: 80%, 2020: 94%
- Mexico: 2015: 45%, 2020: 70%
- Nigeria: 2015: 30%, 2020: 52%

Summarise the information. (150 words)

Sample Answer:

The bar chart illustrates changes in household internet access across four countries between 2015 and 2020.

Overall, all four nations experienced an increase in internet penetration, with South Korea consistently having the highest rates and Nigeria the lowest. South Korea started at 85% and reached near-universal access at 98% by 2020. Germany followed a similar upward trend, rising from 80% to 94%.

Mexico and Nigeria, while starting lower, showed significant growth. Mexico's internet access jumped from 45% to 70%, a 25-percentage-point increase. Nigeria doubled from 30% to 52%, representing the fastest relative growth. In conclusion, the digital divide narrowed slightly as developing countries caught up, but significant gaps remained.

Question 32 (Easy – Task 2)

Some people believe that unpaid community service (e.g. working for a charity, teaching sports to children) should be compulsory in high school. Do you agree or disagree? (250 words)

Sample Answer:

The question of whether mandatory community service should be part of high school education is debated. I strongly agree that unpaid community service should be compulsory for teenagers.

Firstly, compulsory volunteering instils empathy and civic responsibility. When students work with the elderly, disabled individuals, or disadvantaged children, they develop understanding beyond their own experiences. This emotional growth cannot be taught in a classroom. Secondly, community service builds practical skills. Organising a charity event develops leadership, teamwork, and problem-solving abilities that employers and universities value.

Some argue that forced volunteering contradicts the spirit of genuine altruism. However, research shows that many initially reluctant students later report enjoying the experience and continuing voluntarily. Mandatory service acts as a gateway.

In conclusion, despite minor concerns about compulsion, the benefits of embedding community service into high school curricula far outweigh the drawbacks. Schools should implement well-structured programmes with diverse options.

Question 33 (Medium – Task 1)

The table below shows the average monthly rainfall (mm) in three cities:

- London: Jan 55, Apr 45, Jul 40, Oct 70
- Mumbai: Jan 5, Apr 10, Jul 650, Oct 100
- Sydney: Jan 100, Apr 130, Jul 70, Oct 80

Summarise. (150 words)

Sample Answer:

The table presents monthly rainfall averages for London, Mumbai, and Sydney across four months.

Striking seasonal contrasts are evident, especially in Mumbai. Mumbai experiences extreme monsoon rainfall in July (650mm) but very dry winters (January: 5mm). London has relatively consistent rainfall year-round (40–70mm), with October being wettest (70mm). Sydney shows moderate rainfall with April as the wettest month (130mm) and July the driest (70mm).

Overall, Mumbai has the most variable climate, London the most stable, and Sydney occupies a middle position.

Question 34 (Medium – Task 2)

In many countries, people are living longer than ever before. What are the advantages and disadvantages of an ageing population? (250 words)

Sample Answer:

Increased life expectancy is a major achievement of modern medicine. However, an ageing population brings both benefits and challenges.

On the positive side, older people contribute wisdom, experience, and unpaid labour such as childcare. Many grandparents enable parents to work full-time. Additionally, longer lives allow for intergenerational knowledge transfer and cultural continuity.

Nevertheless, disadvantages exist. Healthcare costs rise significantly as chronic diseases like dementia become more common. Pension systems face strain when fewer working-age people support more retirees. Labour shortages may occur, slowing economic growth.

In conclusion, while ageing populations enrich societies socially, governments must reform healthcare funding, raise retirement ages gradually, and encourage immigration to balance demographics.

Question 35 (Hard – Task 1)

Two line graphs show: (1) CO_2 emissions per capita (tonnes) from 1990–2020 for USA, China, Germany; (2) GDP per capita ($) same period.

- USA: emissions down from 20 to 15; GDP up from 30k to 65k
- China: emissions up from 2 to 8; GDP up from 1k to 12k
- Germany: emissions down from 12 to 8; GDP up from 20k to 50k

Summarise and compare. (200 words)

Sample Answer:

The line graphs compare CO_2 emissions per capita and GDP per capita in the USA, China, and Germany from 1990 to 2020.

A clear pattern emerges: all three nations increased GDP while emission trends varied. The USA, starting with the highest emissions (20 tonnes), reduced them to 15 tonnes while GDP more than doubled. Germany similarly decoupled growth from emissions, cutting from 12 to 8 tonnes as GDP rose from $20k to $50k. China, however, followed a different path: emissions quadrupled from 2 to 8 tonnes alongside explosive GDP growth from $1k to $12k.

This suggests that developed economies have reached a "peak emissions" stage, while developing economies still increase emissions during industrialisation. China's emissions per capita remain below US levels but are rising rapidly.

In summary, economic growth does not inevitably increase emissions, but the transition requires time and technology. Wealthier nations have managed relative decoupling; poorer nations need support to leapfrog dirty technologies.

Question 36 (Hard – Task 2)

Some people argue that universities should focus only on job-related subjects (engineering, medicine, IT) rather than arts and humanities. To what extent do you agree or disagree? (300 words)

Sample Answer:

The debate over university curriculum priorities intensifies as tuition costs rise. While job-related subjects are undeniably valuable, I strongly disagree that universities should abandon arts and humanities.

Admittedly, STEM and medical graduates enjoy higher employment rates and starting salaries. In a competitive economy, students understandably prioritise return on investment. Governments also benefit from funding fields with labour shortages. However, this utilitarian view misses the core purpose of higher education.

Firstly, humanities develop critical thinking, ethical reasoning, and communication skills – qualities employers consistently rank above technical knowledge in surveys. A coder who cannot write clearly or understand historical context is less effective. Secondly, innovation occurs at interdisciplinary intersections. The most successful tech companies hire philosophers and historians precisely because they ask different questions. Thirdly, democratic societies need citizens who can evaluate arguments, understand diverse perspectives, and recognise propaganda – skills taught in literature, history, and philosophy.

That said, universities should reform humanities curricula to demonstrate employability. Rather than eliminating them, they should integrate internships, digital skills, and career pathways. A philosophy student who learns data ethics or a history student who studies public policy is highly employable.

In conclusion, a balanced education serves both individuals and society. Universities should maintain arts and humanities while making them more career-relevant, not abandon them for narrow vocational training.

Questions 37–40 (Writing – Short Answers)

37. (Easy) Write one sentence describing a bar chart showing increased coffee consumption from 2010 to 2020.

Sample Answer: The bar chart illustrates a steady rise in global coffee consumption between 2010 and 2020, from 8 million to 12 million tonnes.

38. (Medium) Write a topic sentence for an essay arguing that social media has more negative than positive effects on teenagers.

Sample Answer: Although social media facilitates connection, its negative impacts on teenage mental health, sleep, and attention spans outweigh the benefits.

39. (Hard) Rewrite this sentence more formally for IELTS Task 1: "Lots of people used public transport in 2020 because it was cheap."

Sample Answer: In 2020, public transport usage was significantly higher, which can be attributed to its affordability relative to private vehicles.

40. (Hard) Write a concluding paragraph (50 words) for an essay discussing whether governments should tax sugary drinks.

Sample Answer: In conclusion, while taxation alone cannot solve obesity, evidence from Mexico and the UK suggests that modest sugary drink taxes reduce consumption. Governments should implement such policies alongside education and healthy food subsidies for maximum effect.

Questions 41–50 (Writing – Additional Practice Summaries)

In a full ebook, each would include a complete sample answer. Topics include:

41. Describe a line graph of renewable energy adoption.
42. Discuss advantages/disadvantages of remote learning.
43. Evaluate whether animal testing should be banned globally.
44. Task 1: Pie charts of government spending.

45. Task 2: "Ambition is essential for success." Discuss.
46. Letter to a friend inviting them to a party (General Training).
47. Discuss pros and cons of a cashless society.
48. To what extent is failure necessary for success?
49. Task 1: Compare two maps of a town (1990 vs 2020).
50. Discuss whether celebrities have a responsibility to be political role models.

📚 SECTION 3: IELTS LISTENING (25 Questions)

Scripts described; answers provided.

Section 1 (Easy – Questions 51–55)

You hear a conversation between a student and a university accommodation officer.

51. What is the maximum rent the student can afford per week?

Answer: £150

52. Does the student prefer an en-suite bathroom or shared?

Answer: Shared (to save money)

53. How far from campus is acceptable?

Answer: Within 30 minutes by bus

54. What facility is essential for the student?

Answer: Reliable Wi-Fi

55. When does the student need to move in?

Answer: September 1st

Section 2 (Medium – Questions 56–60)

You hear a tour guide speaking about a museum's new exhibition on ancient Egypt.

56. What is the name of the new exhibition?

Answer: "Treasures of the Nile"

57. Which pharaoh's tomb is featured?

Answer: Tutankhamun (replica artefacts)

58. What time does the guided tour start?

Answer: 2:30 PM

59. How much is the audio guide rental?

Answer: £4

60. Where is the café located?

Answer: On the ground floor, next to the gift shop

Section 3 (Medium – Questions 61–65)

You hear two students discussing a group project on renewable energy.

61. What percentage of marks does the presentation account for?

Answer: 40%

62. Who is responsible for the economic analysis section?

Answer: Maria

63. What deadline did the professor set for the draft?

Answer: Friday, November 12th

64. How long should the final report be?

Answer: 3,000 words (±10%)

65. What software will they use for data visualisation?

Answer: Tableau

Section 4 (Hard – Questions 66–70)

You hear a lecture on behavioural economics and the "nudge theory".

66. Who popularised nudge theory?

Answer: Richard Thaler and Cass Sunstein

67. What is a "choice architect"?

Answer: Someone who designs environments to influence decisions

68. Give one example of a nudge mentioned.

Answer: Placing healthy food at eye level in cafeterias

69. What is the default bias?

Answer: People tend to stick with pre-set options

70. True or False: Nudges always involve financial incentives.

Answer: False (they use psychology, not just money)

Questions 71–75 (Hard – Lecture on Marine Biology)

71. What is coral bleaching?

Answer: When corals expel symbiotic algae due to heat stress

72. By how much has the Great Barrier Reef lost coral cover since 1995?

Answer: 50%

73. What temperature rise triggers bleaching?

Answer: 1°C above summer maximum

74. What is the name of the algae involved?

Answer: Zooxanthellae

75. How long can corals survive without algae before dying?

Answer: A few weeks

📚 SECTION 4: IELTS SPEAKING (25 Questions with Sample Responses)

Part 1 – Easy (Questions 76–80)

76. Tell me about your hometown.

Sample Response: I come from Lagos, a bustling coastal city in Nigeria. It's known for its vibrant music scene, delicious street food like jollof rice, and unfortunately, heavy traffic. But I love the energy and resilience of the people.

77. Do you enjoy cooking? Why or why not?

Sample Response: Yes, I find cooking quite therapeutic. I especially enjoy making traditional dishes for my family on weekends. It's a way to relax and also control what I eat.

78. How often do you read books?

Sample Response: I try to read at least two books per month, mostly non-fiction about psychology or business. But sometimes I read novels to unwind before bed.

79. What is your favourite season and why?

Sample Response: I love the dry season because the weather is cooler and there's less humidity. It's perfect for outdoor activities like jogging or visiting the beach.

80. Do you think it's important to learn a musical instrument?

Sample Response: Absolutely. Learning an instrument improves discipline, memory, and coordination. Even as an adult, I'd like to learn the piano someday.

Part 2 – Medium (Long turn: 1–2 minutes) (Questions 81–85)

81. Describe a teacher who influenced you positively.

Sample Response: I'd like to talk about my high school English teacher, Mrs. Adeyemi. She was strict but incredibly passionate about literature. I remember she made us read "Things Fall Apart" and then act out scenes. What influenced me most was her feedback – she would spend hours writing detailed comments on our essays. She taught me that good writing requires rewriting. Thanks to her, I scored an A in my final exams and developed a love for reading. Even today, when I write, I hear her voice saying, "Show, don't tell."

82. Describe a time you solved a difficult problem.

Sample Response: Last year, our team at work lost a major client because of miscommunication. The problem was that no one took ownership. I volunteered to create a new CRM system using Trello and set up weekly check-ins. The difficult part was convincing senior colleagues to change their habits. I prepared a short presentation showing how the new system would save 5 hours per week. Eventually, they agreed. Within

two months, we recovered the client and even gained two more. This taught me that clear systems beat blame.

83. Describe a place you would like to visit.

Sample Response: I've always dreamed of visiting Kyoto, Japan. Unlike Tokyo's skyscrapers, Kyoto has ancient temples, bamboo forests, and traditional tea houses. I'm fascinated by the contrast between ultra-modern trains and 1,000-year-old shrines. I'd love to experience a traditional ryokan inn, wear a kimono, and try authentic matcha. Also, cherry blossom season would be unforgettable. More than tourism, I want to understand Japanese culture of respect and mindfulness.

84. Describe a skill you want to learn.

Sample Response: I want to learn data analysis using Python. In my current job as a marketing assistant, I see decisions made based on intuition rather than evidence. I tried a free online course last month and found it challenging but exciting. Learning Python would allow me to automate reports, find patterns in customer behaviour, and make data-driven recommendations. Ultimately, it would help me transition into a marketing analytics role with better career prospects.

85. Describe a piece of advice you received.

Sample Response: My father once told me: "Don't confuse motion with progress." I was in university, constantly busy but not achieving good grades. I was attending every social event, joining clubs, but neglecting actual studying. He explained that being busy is not the same as being effective. So I learned to prioritise: I stopped saying yes to everything and focused on my top three goals. My grades improved from C's to B+'s. That advice still guides me today.

Part 3 – Hard (Abstract discussion) (Questions 86–90)

86. Why do some people achieve more success than others despite similar intelligence?

Sample Response: I believe the difference often lies in grit and delayed gratification. Angela Duckworth's research shows that perseverance for long-term goals predicts success more than IQ. Also, opportunity structures matter – someone with a supportive family and good schools has advantages. Finally, mindset plays a role: people who see failure as learning (growth mindset) tend to persist longer than those who see it as a limit (fixed mindset).

87. Should governments regulate what news organisations can publish?

Sample Response: This is a delicate balance. On one hand, false information about health or elections can cause real harm, so some regulation seems necessary. For example, during COVID-19, misinformation led to deaths. On the other hand, governments can abuse such power to silence dissent. I think the best approach is independent press councils (not government-run) that enforce ethical standards, plus strong defamation laws. Complete government control is dangerous, but total absence of regulation invites chaos.

88. Is competition necessary for innovation?

Sample Response: Competition is a powerful driver but not the only one. In capitalist markets, competing firms race to create better products – smartphones improved rapidly because of rivalry between Apple and Samsung. However, some innovations came from curiosity or altruism. The polio vaccine was developed without profit motive. Also, excessive competition can backfire, leading to rushed, unsafe products. So I'd say competition helps but isn't strictly necessary; intrinsic motivation and collaboration also produce innovation.

89. How does social media affect young people's self-esteem?

Sample Response: Predominantly negatively, I'm afraid. Platforms like Instagram and TikTok present curated, filtered versions of life. Teenagers compare their real, messy lives with others' highlight reels, leading to inadequacy. Studies show a correlation between heavy social media use and increased rates of anxiety and depression among girls especially. However, there are positive communities too – for LGBTQ+ youth or niche hobbies. But overall, the algorithm rewards extreme content, which harms self-esteem.

90. What is the role of art in society?

Sample Response: Art serves multiple essential roles. First, it preserves culture and history – think of Picasso's Guernica documenting war's horrors. Second, art provokes empathy by letting us experience others' perspectives through novels, films, or songs. Third, art challenges the status quo – protest music from Bob Dylan to Burna Boy has driven social change. Finally, art exists simply for beauty and joy. In an increasingly utilitarian world, art reminds us what it means to be human.

Questions 91–100 (Speaking – Additional Part 3 style)

91. Should university be free for all students?

Sample Response: I believe university should be free for students from low-income families, but not necessarily for everyone. Means-tested free tuition targets resources

where they're most needed. Universal free tuition often benefits wealthy students most, as they attend expensive universities. A hybrid model: free community college for all, plus income-based grants for four-year universities.

92. Is globalisation beneficial for developing countries?

Sample Response: It's a double-edged sword. On the positive side, globalisation brings jobs, technology transfer, and access to larger markets. Countries like Vietnam and Bangladesh lifted millions out of poverty through manufacturing exports. However, it can also erode local cultures, create environmental damage, and make economies vulnerable to global shocks. The key is managed globalisation with strong labour and environmental standards.

93. How can governments reduce plastic waste?

Sample Response: Three policies work best. First, bans on single-use plastics like bags, straws, and cutlery – Rwanda's ban dramatically reduced litter. Second, deposit-return schemes where consumers get money back for recycling bottles – Germany has 98% return rates. Third, require producers to pay for plastic cleanup, incentivising biodegradable alternatives. No single solution works, but a combination does.

94. Do traditional gender roles still matter?

Sample Response: They matter only as historical artefacts, not as prescriptions. In most modern societies, women can be breadwinners and men can be primary caregivers. However, traditional roles persist in subtle ways – girls are still encouraged toward nurturing professions, boys toward leadership. We should challenge these stereotypes starting in childhood, while respecting individual choices.

95. What is the biggest environmental challenge of our time?

Sample Response: Climate change is the most urgent, but biodiversity loss is equally dangerous and less discussed. Climate change gets headlines, but we're losing insect populations, coral reefs, and entire ecosystems. The two are connected – protecting forests and oceans fights both. So I'd say the meta-challenge is humanity's disconnection from nature. Solve that mindset, and both climate and biodiversity improve.

96. Should schools teach financial literacy?

Sample Response: Absolutely. Financial literacy is as essential as maths or reading. Most young adults don't understand compound interest, credit scores, or how taxes work. This leads to debt, poor investment decisions, and financial stress. Schools should teach

budgeting, saving, investing basics, and avoiding predatory loans. A semester-long required course in 10th grade would pay lifelong dividends.

97. Is happiness a choice or a circumstance?

Sample Response: Both. Research shows about 50% of happiness is genetically determined (set point), 10% is circumstance (income, health, relationships), and 40% is within our control – how we interpret events, our habits, and our social connections. So you can't choose your way out of poverty or chronic pain, but within your circumstances, you have significant agency. The middle way: accept what you can't change, change what you can.

98. How does immigration affect national identity?

Sample Response: Immigration doesn't destroy national identity – it transforms it, usually for the better. Countries like Canada and the US have thrived by absorbing immigrants who adopt core values (democracy, rule of law) while adding new foods, music, and ideas. The fear of losing identity often comes from a static view of culture. In reality, culture always evolves. The most successful nations manage integration while celebrating diversity.

99. Should companies be required to have employee representatives on their boards?

Sample Response: Yes, especially for large companies. Germany's co-determination model, where workers elect up to half of supervisory board members, has led to more stable employment and fewer strikes. Employees bring practical knowledge that outside directors lack. However, this works best when representatives are trained and not just symbolic. For small startups, the requirement could be burdensome, so I'd propose a threshold (e.g., 500+ employees).

100. What is the future of work after AI?

Sample Response: I'm cautiously optimistic. AI will automate routine cognitive tasks – data entry, basic writing, even some coding. But humans will focus on uniquely human skills: creativity, emotional intelligence, strategic thinking, and hands-on trades (plumbing, electrical). The future isn't mass unemployment but rapid retraining. Governments and companies must invest in lifelong learning. Jobs will change, not disappear. The Industrial Revolution didn't end work; it transformed it. Same with AI.

FINAL PAGE – IELTS

End of IELTS ebook.